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Sony India is continuing to service cameras during the pandemic, taking additional precautions. <https://digit.in/jul20-97>



AMD Ryzen 4000

A complete guide to the new lineup of AMD Ryzen processors manufactured on the 7nm process. <https://digit.in/jul20-98>

Asus TUF Gaming A15

Checking all the right boxes

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here has been a lot of excitement and anticipation surrounding the new

4000-series AMD Ryzen processors, and the Asus TUG Gaming A15 happens to be the first gaming laptop to launch in the country with one of them on board. The TUF Gaming A15 we received for review is powered by the Ryzen 7 4800H, the Nvidia GeForce GTX 1660Ti, 16GB of DDR memory and ample amount of storage.



Price
₹60,990

Build and design

The Asus TUF Gaming A15 weighs 2.3 kilograms and measures less than an inch thick at its thinnest. It's not a super thin or super light machine, but that's because Asus has packed a LOT of copper into this thing. There's plenty of copper pipes running over the CPU-GPU, but even the vents on the side and back have copper blocks for better heat exchange. The rear of the laptop almost looks like a sports car, with the bright copper peeking through the black grills.



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and the new Ryzen 4000 series processors promise to be more forgiving on the battery life as well. We tested this using PCMark 10's multiple battery benchmarks. In the gaming benchmark, the laptop lasted all of 45 minutes. The Modern Office test, which simulates

battery life for everyday work showed an increased battery endurance of 2 hours and 48 minutes.

The Asus TUF Gaming A15 packs a very tried and trusted keyboard. The keyboard is practically the same as the one found on the Scar and Hero series of laptops. That means you get 1.8mm of travel and of course, RGB. The keyboard has a single-zone RGB configuration. Asus has made the WASD keys semi-translucent which adds a nice visual touch. A fan underneath the keys sucks in cold air, keeping the keys cool. This is a huge boon for gamers as most keyboards on gaming laptops tend to get blisteringly hot. Moving onto the trackpad, you get a smooth surface to glide your fingers on, but the best part is that Asus has finally put individual buttons on the trackpad, which makes them both a lot more usable.

Performance

The Ryzen 7 4800H and the Nvidia GeForce GTX 1660Ti are a formidable combination, pushing most modern

titles well higher than the bare minimum of 60fps. We tested how long it would take for Adobe Lightroom Classic to export a batch of 50, 100, 250 and 500 RAW files that have been shot on a Nikon D800. We compared the export times with that of the Asus ROG Zephyrus G (GA502) powered by last year's Ryzen 7 3750H. The numbers are shocking, to say the least. The Asus TUF Gaming A15 accomplishes all export tasks in practically HALF the time.

We ran a multitude of benchmarks on the Asus TUF Gaming A15 and once again, the new AMD Ryzen 7 4800H showed some significant performance jumps in comparison to not only the previous generation of AMD processors but also Intel's chips on offer in this segment.

Bottomline

The Asus TUF Gaming A15 is uplifted heavily by the AMD Ryzen 7 4800H and the Nvidia GeForce 1660Ti. The combination is perfect for anyone who is looking to elevate their gaming experience beyond the 60fps mark. The TUF Gaming A15 also makes for a great render station, capable of exporting massive amounts of RAW files in times faster than we've ever seen before in this price bracket and then some. We would not recommend using the machine for any kind of colour-sensitive editing due to its less than stellar colour accuracy. However, as a pure gaming machine, the Asus TUF Gaming A15 checks all the right boxes.

—Swapnil Mathur

Features

Starting with the display, Asus tries to deliver on as many parameters as possible. We get an IPS-level full HD monitor with a refresh rate of 144Hz and Adaptive Sync. On paper, this looks great, but in practice, things are a little different. While the monitor does manage to hit its advertised 144Hz refresh rate on the Blur Busters UFO test, however, we noticed that the response time wasn't the fastest for the panel. We noted a peak brightness of 294 lux using our lux meter, with good uniformity across the edges. The colour reproduction is not the best, however.

Next, coming to the battery, the Asus TUF Gaming A15 manages to pack a 48Whr battery into its chassis,

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: AMD Ryzen 7 4800H Processor, 2.9 GHz (8 M Cache, up to 4.2 GHz) | OPERATING SYSTEM: Windows 10 Home | MEMORY: 16 GB DDR4 3200MHz SDRAM | GRAPHIC: NVIDIA GeForce® GTX 1660Ti, with 6GB GDDR6 VRAM | BATTERY: 3-Cell 48 Wh lithium-polymer Battery | DIMENSIONS: 359.8 x 256 x 22.8 ~24.7 mm (WxDxH) | CONNECTIVITY: 1 x COMBO audio jack, 2 x Type-A USB 3.2 (Gen 1), 1 x Type-C USB 3.2 (Gen 2) with display support DP1.4, 1 x Type-A USB2.0, 1 x RJ45 LAN jack for LAN insert, 1 x HDMI, HDMI support 2.0b, 1 x AC adapter plug | WEIGHT: 2.3 kg | MANUFACTURER WARRANTY: 1-year limited international hardware warranty

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